

DTD Education Lane

What To Research and What Should Show on the Website

1. Purpose

This document defines what DTD should research for the Education lane and what the final learner-facing website should show.

DTD Education is not a generic dog training library.

It is a structured decision-support layer for new dog owners. It helps owners understand what may be happening, avoid making things worse, take better next steps, and prepare for trainer support when needed.

The website should not show everything researched.

Research is the evidence and planning layer.

The website should show only the practical, concise, owner-facing layer.

2. Research Rule

Research should answer this question:

What does a new dog owner need to notice, avoid, change, practise, track, or escalate before trainer matching?

Do not research topics only because they are popular dog training topics.

Research must support at least one DTD Education objective:

- reduce owner confusion
 - improve owner judgment
 - prevent accidental escalation
 - build calm routines
 - identify when education is not enough
 - prepare owners for trainer support
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Part A — What To Research

3. Research Area 1: New Owner Confusion

What to research

Research common situations where new dog owners misunderstand what is happening.

Focus on:

- normal puppy adjustment
- recently adopted dog adjustment
- fear versus stubbornness
- over-arousal versus disobedience
- boredom versus bad behaviour
- unmet needs
- poor routine
- poor environment setup
- sudden behaviour change
- illness red flags that can look behavioural

Research questions

- What behaviours do new owners commonly misread?
- What is normal in the early adjustment period?
- What signs suggest the dog needs space?
- What signs suggest the dog is overwhelmed?
- What signs suggest the issue may be medical?
- What signs suggest trainer support may be needed?

Website final state

Show this as:

- “What might be happening?” panels
- simple owner interpretation guides
- short scenario-based explanations
- red flag callouts
- “not all behaviour is training” reminders

Do not show:

- long behavioural theory
 - clinical explanations
 - academic terminology
 - diagnosis-style wording
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4. Research Area 2: Owner Mistakes That Make Problems Worse

What to research

Research common owner reactions that accidentally worsen behaviour.

Focus on mistakes such as:

- punishing after-the-fact toileting accidents
- forcing scared dogs toward triggers
- yelling “no” without changing the setup
- giving too much freedom too soon
- rewarding the wrong behaviour by accident
- overstimulating a tired puppy
- ignoring early stress signals
- overusing food to lure instead of changing distance
- treating fear as stubbornness
- delaying help when problems escalate

Research questions

- What mistakes are most common for new dog owners?
- Which mistakes worsen fear?
- Which mistakes worsen toileting problems?
- Which mistakes worsen biting or mouthing?
- Which mistakes worsen barking or guarding?
- Which mistakes create confusion in learning?
- What safer alternative should replace each mistake?

Website final state

Show this as:

- “Common mistake” callouts
- “Do this instead” sections
- short decision rules
- scenario examples
- checklist items

Example website format:

Common mistake: Pulling the dog closer to the scary object.
Better move: Step back first. Let the dog feel safe before trying again.

Do not show:

- blame-heavy wording
- owner shaming
- long explanations of why owners are wrong
- complex behaviour-modification theory

5. Research Area 3: Calm Home Setup and Early Routines

What to research

Research how new owners can reduce problems through environment and routine.

Focus on:

- safe home setup
- rest zones
- crate or pen use as a calm area
- sleep and decompression needs
- toileting routines
- feeding routine basics
- supervision
- indoor freedom boundaries
- alone-time foundations
- household consistency
- first vet visit preparation
- cost awareness

Research questions

- What home setup prevents common early problems?
- What hazards should new owners remove?
- How should rest areas be introduced?
- What routines help puppies settle?
- What routines help adopted dogs adjust?
- How should owners manage indoor freedom?
- What should owners ask at the first vet visit?
- What early costs should owners expect?

Website final state

Show this as:

- setup checklist
- first-week roadmap
- “Do This Now” tasks
- rest-zone guidance
- simple routine cards
- family agreement prompts

Example website format:

Today's setup task:
Create one quiet rest zone away from foot traffic.

Do not show:

- full shopping guides

- brand recommendations
 - product reviews
 - long crate-training lectures
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6. Research Area 4: Early Puppy and New Dog Problems

What to research

Research common early problems that create owner stress.

Focus on:

- toileting accidents
- puppy biting and mouthing
- chewing furniture or shoes
- crying or unsettled behaviour
- difficulty settling
- over-arousal
- new dog adjustment
- owner overwhelm
- routine breakdown

Research questions

- What early problems are normal?
- What early problems need routine changes?
- What early problems need trainer help?
- What early problems need vet review?
- What should the owner try first?
- What should the owner stop doing?
- What should the owner track?

Website final state

Show this as:

- short scenario modules
- “first response” guidance
- mistake prevention
- action checklists
- progress signs
- escalation prompts

Example website format:

If your puppy toilets inside after being outside, do not punish them. Tighten supervision, return to the same toileting spot, and reward immediately when they go outside.

Do not show:

- broad “puppy training tips”
 - full obedience programmes
 - guarantees such as “stop accidents fast”
 - unsafe or absolute claims
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7. Research Area 5: Reading Dog Behaviour

What to research

Research beginner-safe dog body language and communication.

Focus on:

- stress signals
- fear signals
- over-arousal signals
- calming or space-seeking behaviours
- signs a dog needs distance
- signs the dog is not coping
- body language owners often misread
- when behaviour change may indicate pain or illness

Research questions

- What body signals should new owners learn first?
- What signs appear before barking, freezing, growling, or lunging?
- What signs suggest the dog needs space?
- What signs suggest over-arousal?
- What signs suggest illness or pain may be involved?
- How can this be explained without heavy jargon?

Website final state

Show this as:

- “Watch for this” cards
- simple visual/body-language guides
- scenario explanations
- “pause and give space” rules
- vet/trainer escalation reminders

Example website format:

If your dog yawns, looks away, or suddenly sniffs the ground during a stressful moment, pause and reduce pressure.

Do not show:

- technical ethology lectures
 - dominance framing
 - unsupported “this always means X” claims
 - diagnosis-style interpretation
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8. Research Area 6: Fear, Socialisation, and Safe Exposure

What to research

Research how owners can prevent accidental fear escalation.

Focus on:

- safe socialisation
- sensitive socialisation period
- exposure versus flooding
- fear periods
- safe puppy exposure before full vaccination
- handling scary objects
- avoiding forced greetings
- small-dog handling
- public exposure mistakes

Research questions

- What should new owners know about safe exposure?
- What is the risk of forcing a scared dog?
- How can owners create distance instead of pressure?
- How should owners manage puppy socialisation safely?
- When should fear be escalated to a trainer?
- What should owners record before seeking help?

Website final state

Show this as:

- safe exposure checklist
- “step back first” rule
- socialisation safety notes
- short fear scenarios
- trainer-readiness prompts

Example website format:

If your dog freezes at a bin, do not lure them closer with food. Step back, wait for their body to soften, and try again from farther away.

Do not show:

- complex desensitisation protocols
 - serious fear treatment plans
 - aggression modification content
 - claims that owners can solve all fear alone
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9. Research Area 7: Reward Timing and Daily Learning

What to research

Research simple learning principles that help owners avoid confusing the dog.

Focus on:

- marker timing
- rewarding the exact moment
- accidental reinforcement
- calm routines
- predictable household rules
- simple cues used for routine
- family consistency
- practice repetition

Research questions

- What timing mistakes do owners make?
- How can marker timing be taught simply?
- What routines are useful for new owners?
- How can family inconsistency confuse the dog?
- What simple rules help the dog understand expectations?

Website final state

Show this as:

- short reward-timing practice
- “Say Please” routine
- family cue-word agreement
- action drills
- spaced review prompts

Example website format:

Mark the good choice the second it happens. If the reward arrives after the dog changes behaviour, reset and try again.

Do not show:

- long operant conditioning theory

- advanced obedience plans
 - formal competition-style training
 - trick training
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10. Research Area 8: Real-World Handling

What to research

Research common outside-world and public-environment problems for new owners.

Focus on:

- loud noises
- traffic
- street rubbish
- dogs panicking on walks
- window barking
- public overstimulation
- leash safety
- owner positioning
- reducing exposure when overwhelmed
- safe management while waiting for trainer help

Research questions

- What overwhelms new dogs in public?
- What should owners do first during sudden noise?
- How should owners manage street rubbish?
- What are common public-handling mistakes?
- When does public stress need trainer support?
- What should owners record for a trainer?

Website final state

Show this as:

- “Shield” guidance
- street hazard decision rules
- public handling checklists
- window barking environment changes
- trainer escalation prompts

Example website format:

If a loud truck passes, create space, stay calm, and help your dog recover before continuing.

Do not show:

- full loose-leash training programmes

- advanced reactivity protocols
 - public behaviour treatment plans
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11. Research Area 9: Freedom, Boundaries, and Regression Prevention

What to research

Research how owners can expand freedom without losing progress.

Focus on:

- gradual room access
- supervision
- indoor leash safety
- secure rest areas
- preventing chewing
- preventing hidden toileting accidents
- signal bell basics
- family consistency
- regression after too much freedom

Research questions

- Why do new dogs regress when given too much freedom?
- How should owners expand access gradually?
- What are safe supervision rules?
- How should owners manage mistakes without punishment?
- How should owners keep rules consistent across the family?
- When does repeated regression need trainer support?

Website final state

Show this as:

- freedom expansion checklist
- supervision rules
- “earn access” guidance
- signal bell outline
- family rules template

Example website format:

Add one new room only after the dog has been reliable in the current space.

Do not show:

- rigid one-size-fits-all rules
- unsafe tethering advice

- punishment-based correction plans
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12. Research Area 10: Escalation and Trainer Readiness

What to research

Research when self-guided education is no longer enough and what owners should prepare before contacting a trainer.

Focus on:

- trainer escalation signs
- vet escalation signs
- safety concerns
- repeated failed attempts
- fear escalation
- biting or aggression red flags
- separation distress signs
- what trainers need from owners
- issue tracking
- trigger logs
- owner goals
- short video examples
- pre-consultation summaries

Research questions

- When should owners contact a trainer?
- When should owners contact a vet first?
- What information improves trainer matching?
- What questions should owners answer before booking?
- What should owners track?
- What should owners avoid doing while waiting for help?
- What should DTD collect to support better trainer matching?

Website final state

Show this as:

- “When to seek help” prompts
- trainer-readiness checklist
- behaviour summary builder
- trigger log
- “what to tell a trainer” template
- soft bridge to trainer search

Example website format:

If this keeps happening, prepare notes before contacting a trainer: what happened, when it happens, what triggers it, how often it happens, and what you have already tried.

Do not show:

- hard-sell trainer prompts
 - fear-based upselling
 - claims that every issue needs paid help
 - claims that the course replaces professional help
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Part B — What Should Show on the Website

13. Website Principle

The website should show the final owner-facing layer, not the research layer.

The website should feel like:

A calm, structured guide for new dog owners.

It should not feel like:

A dog training encyclopaedia.

14. Main Education Dashboard

The dashboard should show:

14.1 Current Journey Status

Example:

Your DTD Education Journey
Current focus: Setting up calm foundations
Next step: Complete The Blueprint

14.2 Curriculum Pathway

Show the structured owner journey, not a generic content library.

Each pathway card should show:

- title
- one-line objective
- status
- next action

14.3 Today's Action

Show one practical action from the current stage.

Example:

Today: Create one quiet rest zone for your dog.

14.4 Owner Capability Tracker

Track capability, not just reading completion.

Possible capabilities:

- safe home setup
- calm routine
- early problem handling
- dog-reading basics
- fear response
- reward timing
- public handling
- freedom boundaries
- trainer readiness

14.5 Trainer Readiness Prompt

Show only when relevant.

Example:

If this keeps repeating or feels unsafe, prepare notes for a trainer.

15. Lesson Page Final State

Each lesson should show:

1. Scenario
2. What the owner needs to notice
3. Common mistake
4. Better decision rule
5. What to do now
6. Watch for this
7. When to seek help
8. Optional trainer-readiness note

Keep each lesson concise.

Do not show long source notes in the main learner flow.

16. Checklist Final State

Show checklists as simple action tools.

Examples:

- Safe home checklist
- First vet visit checklist
- Potty routine checklist
- Calm rest zone checklist
- Fear response checklist
- Trainer-readiness checklist

Each checklist item should be practical and observable.

Example:

Move cleaning supplies into a high or locked cabinet.

Avoid vague items such as:

Learn about puppy safety.

17. Decision Rule Final State

Show decision rules as short reusable cards.

Examples:

If your dog is scared, create distance first.

If your puppy has an accident, clean quietly and tighten supervision.

If behaviour changes suddenly, consider health or pain before treating it as training.

If the issue repeats or feels unsafe, prepare notes for a trainer.

These are core DTD Education assets.

18. Escalation Prompt Final State

Escalation prompts should be calm and clear.

Example:

Education may not be enough if this keeps happening, gets worse, or feels unsafe.
Prepare notes and consider trainer support.

Vet-related example:

If your dog seems unwell, has sudden behaviour changes, repeated vomiting, severe lethargy, or possible toxin exposure, contact a vet.

Avoid:

- panic language
 - hard selling
 - overconfident diagnosis
 - “fix this yourself” wording
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19. Trainer Readiness Final State

Trainer-readiness tools should help the owner prepare useful information.

Show prompts such as:

- What happened?
- When does it happen?
- What usually happens before it?
- How often does it happen?
- What have you tried?
- What changed recently?
- Is anyone unsafe?
- Do you have a short video?

Final output could be:

Trainer Summary

Containing:

- main concern
 - trigger pattern
 - frequency
 - owner attempts
 - safety concern
 - desired outcome
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20. What Should Not Show on the Website

Do not show as main website content:

- research notes
- long citations inside lessons
- academic summaries
- dense theory
- trainer-level protocols
- medical treatment instructions
- product rankings
- breed stereotypes
- generic dog training blog posts
- SEO filler
- long video-course style pages

Research can exist internally, but the learner sees the distilled guidance.

21. Final Website Content Test

Before showing any Education content on the website, ask:

Does this help the owner make a better decision?

If no, remove or revise.

Does this help the owner avoid making the situation worse?

If no, revise.

Does this show what to do next?

If no, revise.

Does this explain when education is not enough?

If relevant and missing, revise.

Does this prepare the owner for trainer support?

If relevant and missing, revise.

Could this be mistaken for generic Google dog advice?

If yes, reframe it around DTD's owner decision-support role.

22. Final Rule

Research broadly enough to understand the issue.

Show narrowly enough that the owner can act.

The website should not display everything DTD knows.

It should display only what helps a new dog owner:

notice better, choose better, act better, and seek help at the right time.